D. James Poer

Senior UX Engineer | Front-End Architect

Port Charlotte, Florida | Remote U.S.

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Professional summary

Senior UX engineer and front-end architect who turns complex business workflows, regulatory requirements, and design intent into usable production software. Combines hands-on Angular and TypeScript engineering with interaction design, usability research, reusable component architecture, and technical leadership. Professional career spans enterprise insurance, government, public education, and automotive retail, with web project work dating to 2003. Current independent work demonstrates modern React 19, Vite 8, interactive 3D, and human-directed AI product development.

Core skills

Engineering: Angular, TypeScript, JavaScript, semantic HTML, Sass/SCSS, CSS, reusable components, design systems, responsive interfaces, REST/JSON integration, service workers and PWAs. Early Angular 2 adopter who helped lead an enterprise migration from AngularJS to Angular.

UX and delivery: Enterprise workflow design, interaction design, discovery, requirements translation, usability testing, prototyping, WCAG, Section 508, Figma, Justinmind, Git/GitHub, Jira, Agile/Scrum, Cloudflare, Vitest, Angular TestBed, axe and Lighthouse.

Professional experience

EXL LifePRO

Senior Web Designer (Lead Assistant Manager) | October 2019 to April 2023 | Indianapolis, Indiana

- Designed approximately 40% of LifePRO v20/v21 screens and workflows for enterprise life, annuity, and health insurance administration, partnering with business analysts, product owners, leadership, and distributed engineering teams.
- Built high-fidelity Justinmind prototypes that translated insurance workflows, business rules, and regulatory constraints into implementable interfaces within the established design system.
- Advised senior leaders and offshore teams on UX, accessibility, and implementation.
- Led systemic Section 508 remediation. Personally resolved core accessibility defects with roughly 150 lines of reusable Sass, avoiding a proposed rewrite of approximately 1.5 million lines of HTML.
- Maintained an independent Angular modernization branch to expose framework and legacy Bootstrap/PrimeNG compatibility risks; this research was separate from the official production application.
- Identified redundant wrappers and tightly coupled UI abstractions; simplified one documented story from 21 to 5 points and contributed to a dynamic screen replacing multiple custom screens.
- Conducted usability tests and coached junior testers on role-based permissions, helping distinguish access restrictions from actual defects.

Indianapolis Public Schools

User Interface Developer | August 2019 to October 2019 | Indianapolis, Indiana

- Customized PowerSchool forms using JavaScript, jQuery, HTML, and CSS. Translated state and federal reporting rules into conditional requirements, dependent-field behavior, and inline validation that blocked known-invalid submissions.

Professional experience continued

TCC Software Solutions

User Experience Developer | May 2015 to June 2019 | Indianapolis, Indiana

- Progressed from Software Developer I into UX Developer II, combining Angular development with research, product design, accessibility, mentoring, and improvements to the UX practice.
- Designed government licensing and regulatory interfaces across the reusable Ascend platform and client implementations, including Oregon Early Learning; supported Section 508 and translation into five languages.
- Co-designed and moderated an approximately 30-session comparative usability study with a business analyst. Combined the strongest findings from both approaches to improve Oregon's implementation and the underlying Ascend product.
- Established a BA/UX working model, helped formalize UX career levels, and participated in hiring and mentoring. Trained developers in semantic HTML, Sass, WCAG, Section 508, and ARIA.
- Led Angular architecture and technical delivery for the Vertex Solutions website on an approximately six-week trade-show deadline, collaborating with visual designers; received Employee of the Month for delivery.
- Took primary front-end ownership of TCC's ASP.NET/MVC.NET corporate site, improving structure, Sass, maintainability, SEO, and performance and adding service-worker/PWA support.

Dreyer & Reinbold

Digital Presence Coordinator | September 2011 to May 2015 | Indianapolis area, Indiana

- Managed digital presence across 11 websites, seven dealerships, and five automotive brands, including content, vehicle photography, HTML email, and inventory/listing integrations.
- Built a BMW month-end finance workflow in an inherited classic ASP intranet, reducing processing from approximately 2.5 days to 15 minutes. Wrote SQL, repaired legacy queries, and trained department interns.

Current independent engineering

Shady White Van | 2026 | shadywhitevan.rocks

- Developed a modern React 19 and TypeScript application with Vite 8, deployed through Cloudflare Workers Static Assets. Implemented a Three.js/WebGL showroom with GLB/glTF assets and Draco loader support, responsive poster fallbacks, deferred 3D startup, and a pause/resume control.

djamespoer.com and Thingamajob | 2026 to present

- Own product direction, UX, architecture, and release acceptance for a production Angular 22 platform. Direct AI-assisted implementation through specifications, code review, focused tests, accessibility checks, and deployment evidence.
- Designed Thingamajob's career-intelligence workflow around an auditable Library of Truth, source provenance, corrections, job evaluation, and factual job-specific résumé generation.

Career break | April 2023 to 2026 | Medical recovery and family responsibilities.

Education and professional development

B.S. Informatics, Indiana University through IUPUI, December 2013. **Certificate of Applied Computer Science**, Purdue University through IUPUI, completed alongside the degree.

MIT xPRO, Designing and Building AI Products and Services, February 2026, 4.80 CEUs. Additional development: AI for Everyone; Customer Experience Specialist; ITIL Foundation; TestDome Angular and HTML/CSS & Bootstrap; UX Design Refresher.